Experiment - 04

Data Modelling and Form Design for a Business Application in Zoho Creator

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AIM

To design and build a functional “Bank Loan Application Form” application in Zoho Creator that demonstrates the correct usage of all thirteen Basic Fields available in the Form Builder — Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select, and Checkbox — and to model the underlying data structure of a real banking loan pre-screening workflow through a properly sectioned form and an auto-generated report view.

PROCEDURE

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1. Data Model Design

Before building the form, the data requirement was analysed and organised into a simple data model, grouping the thirteen Basic Fields under four logical sections that map to the stages of a loan applicant's journey: Personal Details, Contact Details, Income & Employment Details, and Loan Details & Consent. Every field submitted through the form flows into a single auto-generated report, Loan_Application_Report, which the bank's loan officers use to filter, pre-screen, and route applications for document verification. The resulting data model is shown below.

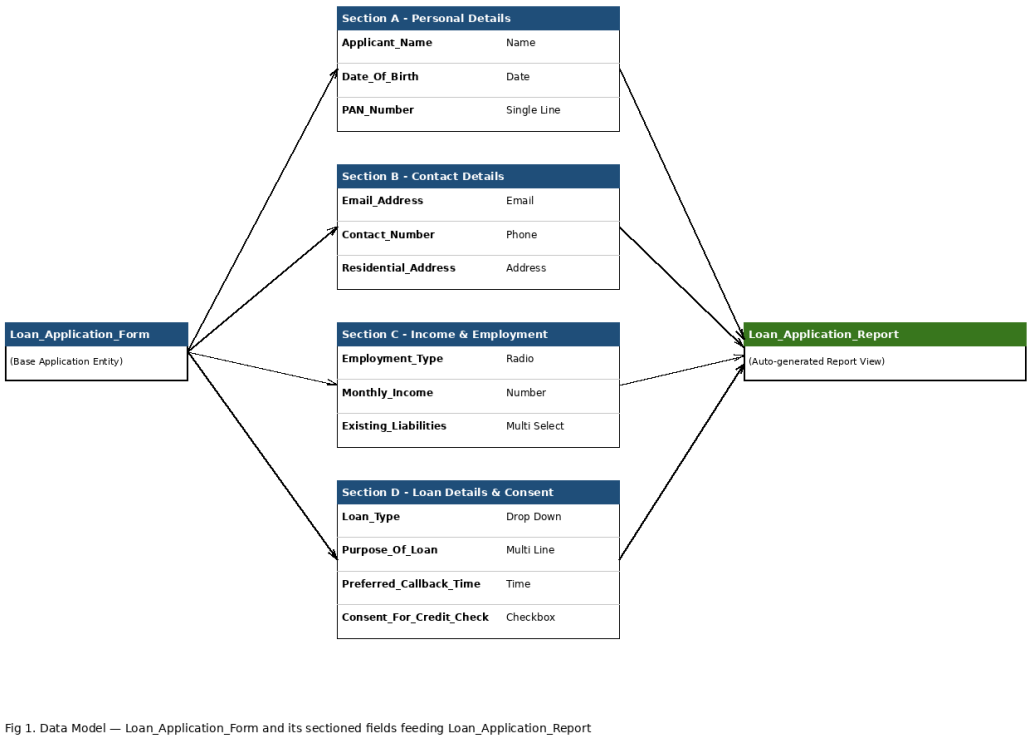


Fig 1. Data Model — Loan_Application_Form and its sectioned fields feeding Loan_Application_Report

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2. Application and Form Creation

- Logged into Zoho Creator and clicked Create New Application → Create from Scratch.
- Named the application "Loan Application and Pre-screening Management" and confirmed creation, which opened the default blank workspace.
- Inside the application, opened the Forms panel and clicked the + icon to add a new form, naming it Loan_Application_Form.
- This automatically created a linked report, Loan_Application_Report, which lists every submitted loan application.

3. Drag-and-Drop of Basic Fields

In the Form Builder, the Basic Fields palette was expanded on the left panel. Each required field was dragged from the palette and dropped onto the canvas in the order needed, then double-clicked to open its Field Properties panel for renaming and configuration, as listed below.

Basic Field	Field Name Set	Drag-and-Drop Configuration
Name	Applicant_Name	Dropped onto canvas; enabled First Name / Last Name sub-fields.
Date	Date_Of_Birth	Dropped in Personal Details section; used for age eligibility checks.
Single Line	PAN_Number	Dropped in Personal Details section; set as mandatory free-text entry.
Email	Email_Address	Dropped in Contact Details section; enabled built-in email format validation.
Phone	Contact_Number	Dropped in Contact Details section; set country code format to India (+91).
Address	Residential_Address	Dropped in Contact Details section; kept default Street/City/State/Country/Zip sub-fields.
Radio	Employment_Type	Dropped in Income & Employment section; mutually exclusive options added (Salaried / Self-Employed / Retired-Unemployed).
Number	Monthly_Income	Dropped in Income & Employment section; minimum value restricted to greater than 0.
Multi Select	Existing_Liabilities	Dropped in Income & Employment section; multiple liability choices added for multi-pick.
Drop Down	Loan_Type	Dropped in Loan Details section; choices list populated with loan product categories.
Multi Line	Purpose_Of_Loan	Dropped in Loan Details section; expanded text area to approximately 4 rows.

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Time	Preferred_Callback_Time	Dropped below Loan_Type; default time format kept as 12-hour.
Checkbox	Consent_For_Credit_Check	Dropped in Loan Details section; marked mandatory so the form cannot submit unchecked.

4. Organising Fields into Sections

To keep the form applicant-friendly and logically grouped, a Section field was dragged from the Layout palette above each group of related fields, and the dropped fields were dragged again to nest them under the correct section header. Four sections were created in this way:

- Section A — Personal Details: Applicant Name, Date of Birth, PAN Number.
- Section B — Contact Details: Email Address, Contact Number, Residential Address.
- Section C — Income & Employment Details: Employment Type, Monthly Income, Existing Liabilities.
- Section D — Loan Details & Consent: Loan Type, Purpose of Loan, Preferred Callback Time, Consent for Credit Check.

Each section header was renamed by double-clicking it and typing the section title, and fields within a section were reordered using drag handles until the layout matched the intended applicant journey from identity to loan consent.

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5. Applying Field-Level Validations

- Selected Applicant_Name, Contact_Number, Date_Of_Birth, Employment_Type, Loan_Type, Monthly_Income, and Consent_For_Credit_Check one by one and enabled the Mandatory toggle in Field Properties.
- Opened Email_Address properties and confirmed the built-in email format validation was active.
- Opened Contact_Number properties and set the phone format to the Indian country-code pattern.
- Opened Monthly_Income properties and set the Minimum Value to a realistic value greater than 0.
- Attempted to restrict Date_Of_Birth so the applicant must be at least 18 years old; Zoho Creator's Basic Date field did not expose a direct age-restriction toggle, so this rule is noted here as a validation to be enforced via a Deluge on-submit script rather than a built-in field property.
- Confirmed under Consent_For_Credit_Check that the Submit button remains disabled until the checkbox is checked.

6. Preview and Deployment

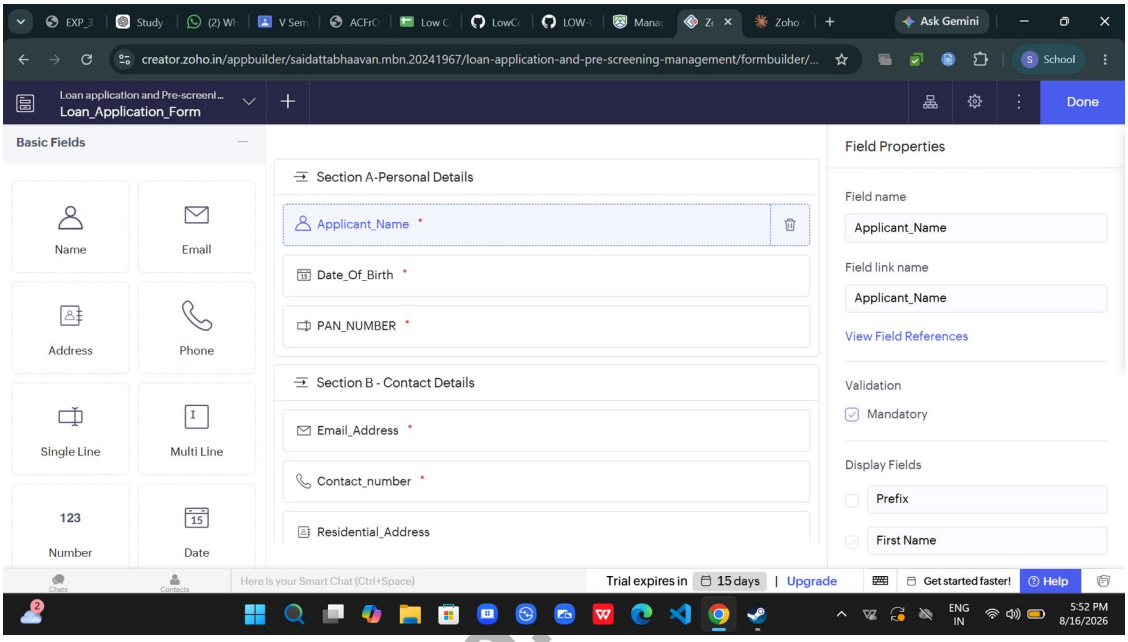
- Clicked the Preview icon in the Form Builder toolbar to view the live applicant-facing form and verified that all four sections render in order with correct field types.
- Filled and submitted three sample loan applications through the preview/live form to test validations and generate report data.
- Opened Loan_Application_Report from the Reports panel and verified that all submitted records appear with values mapped correctly to each field.

- Reviewed the report records to confirm the front office / loan officer can pre-screen applications by Loan Type and Monthly Income, as intended by the workflow.

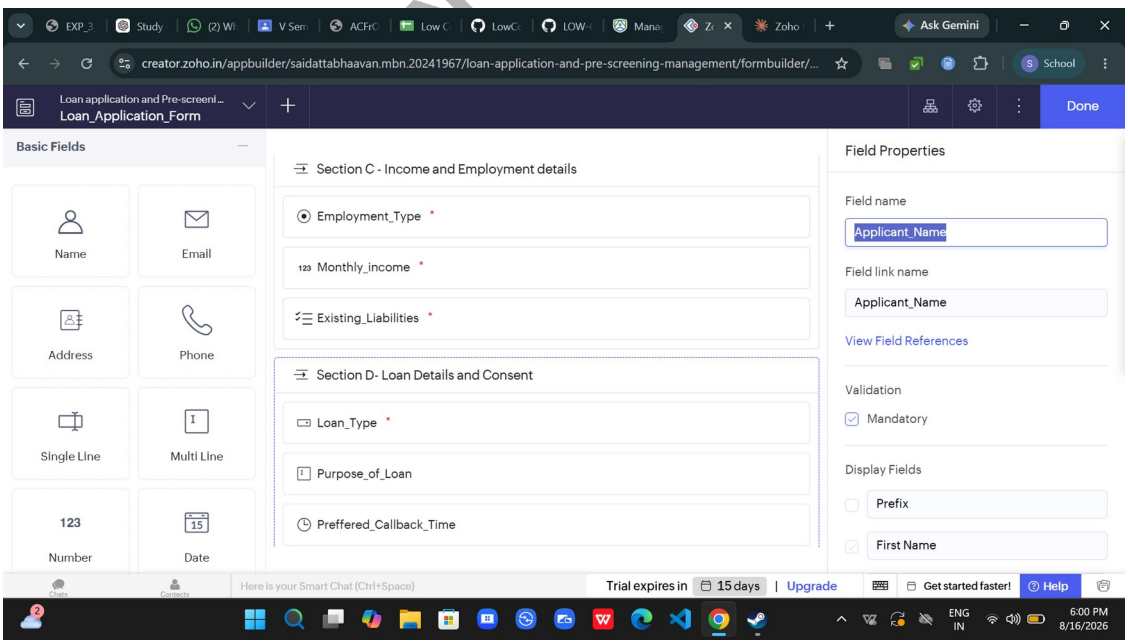
OUTPUT

The following screenshots capture the completed application: the Form Builder showing all thirteen Basic Fields arranged into four sections, the live applicant-facing form preview, and the Loan_Application_Report containing sample submitted records.

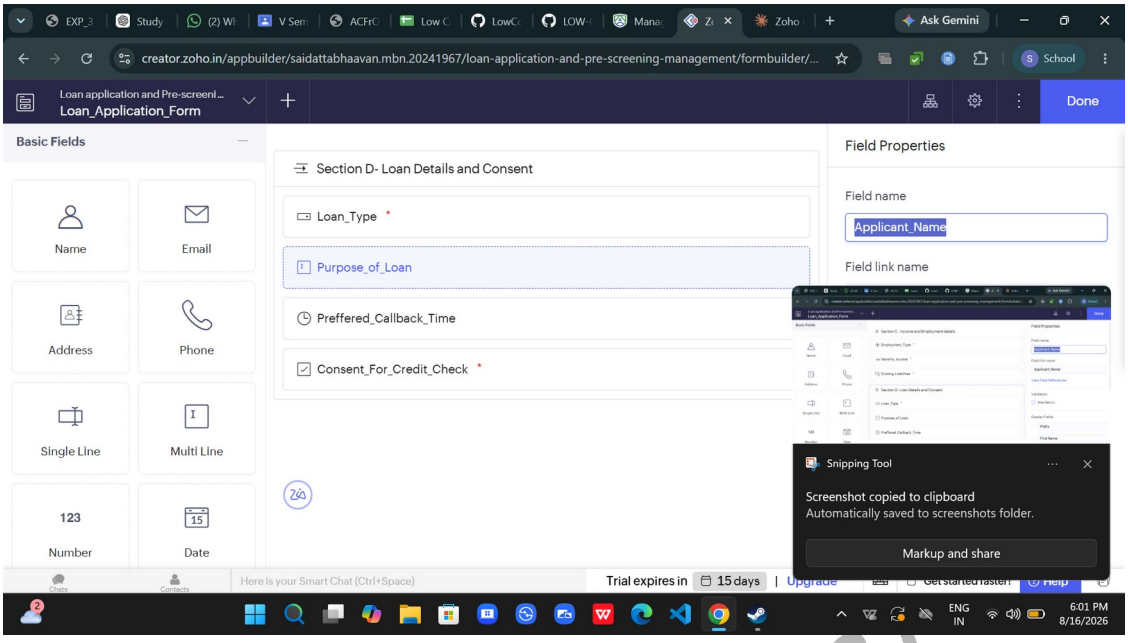
1. Form Builder View — All Basic Fields Placed and Sectioned



Form Builder — Section A (Personal Details) and Section B (Contact Details)

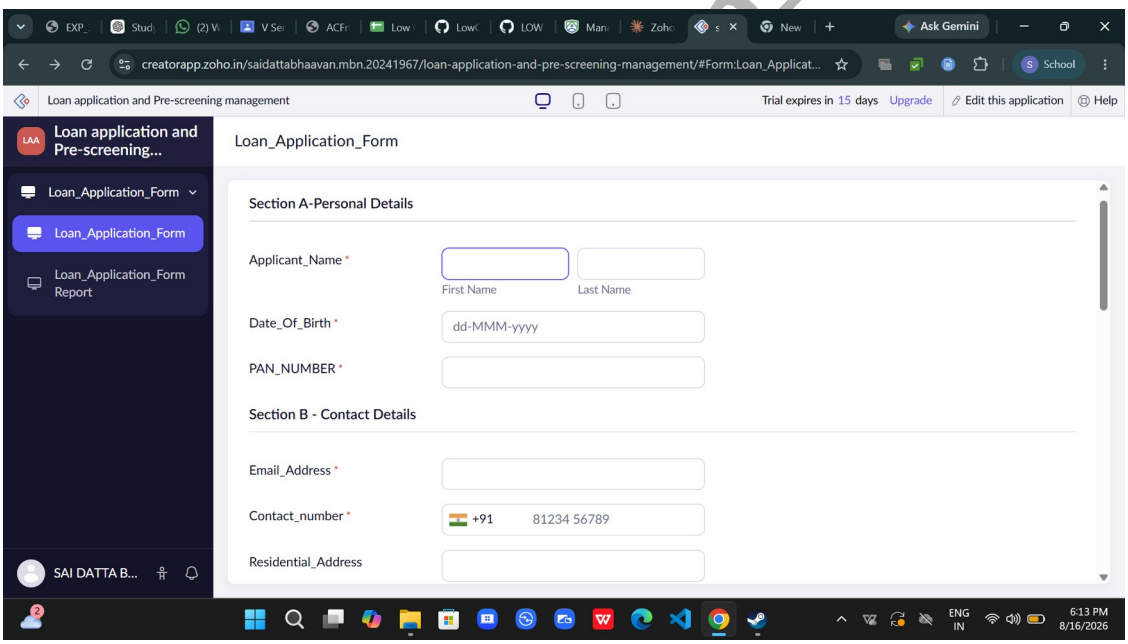


Form Builder — Section C (Income & Employment Details) and start of Section D

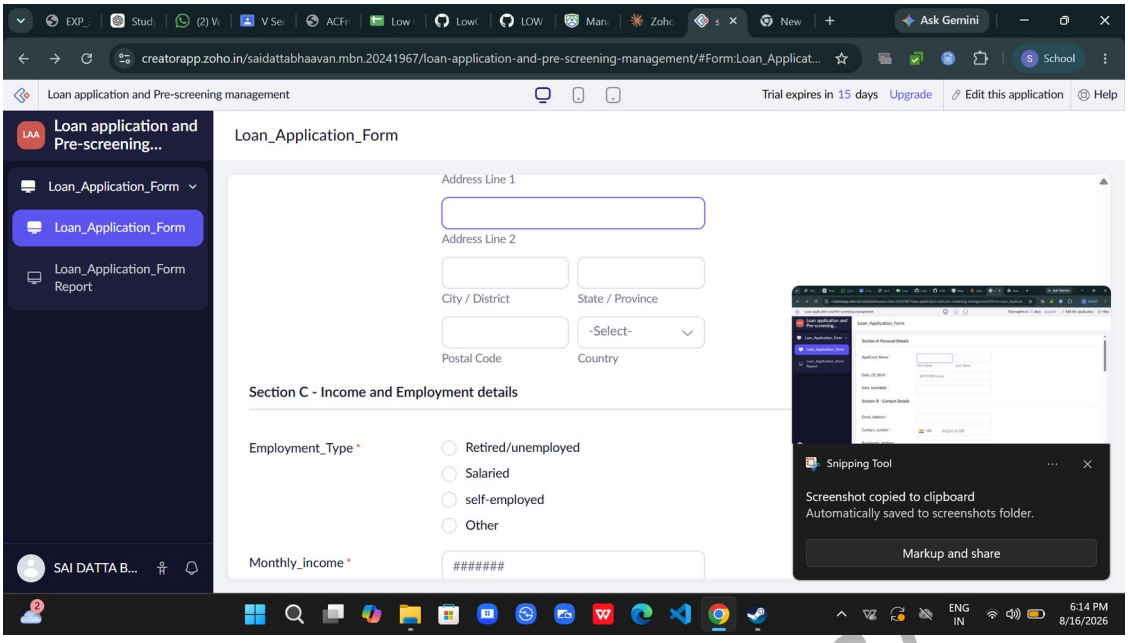


Form Builder — Section D (Loan Details & Consent) fully placed

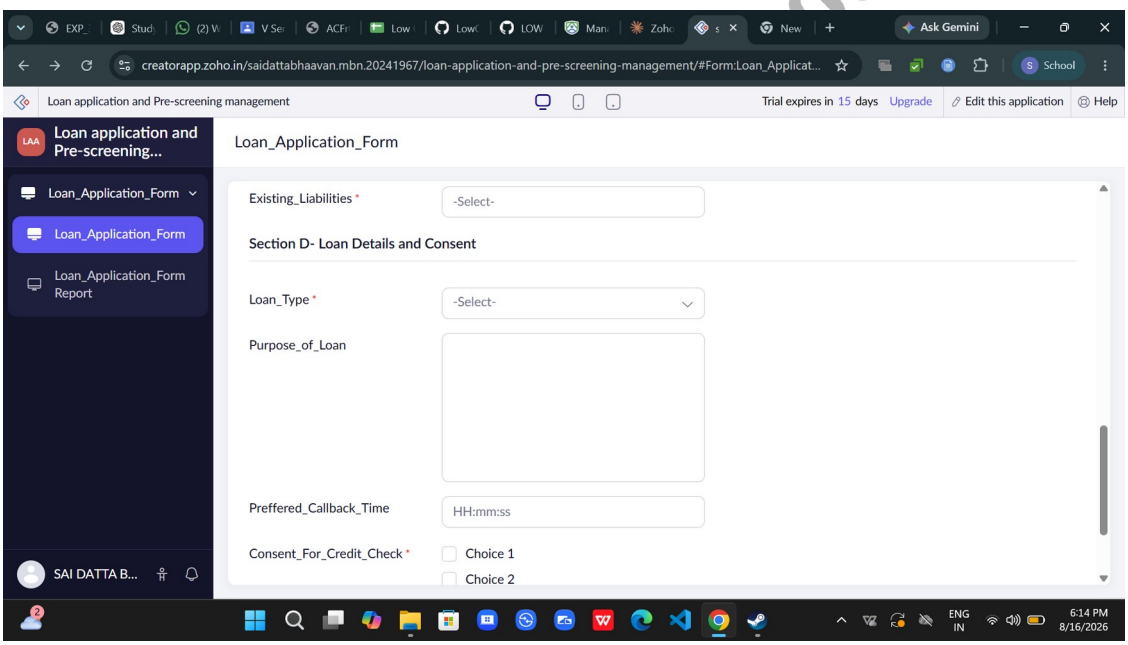
2. Live Form Preview



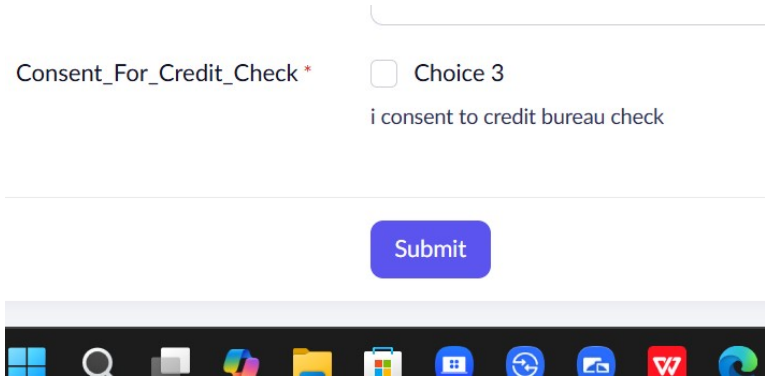
Live Preview — Section A (Personal Details) and Section B (Contact Details)



Live Preview — Residential Address and Section C (Employment Type)



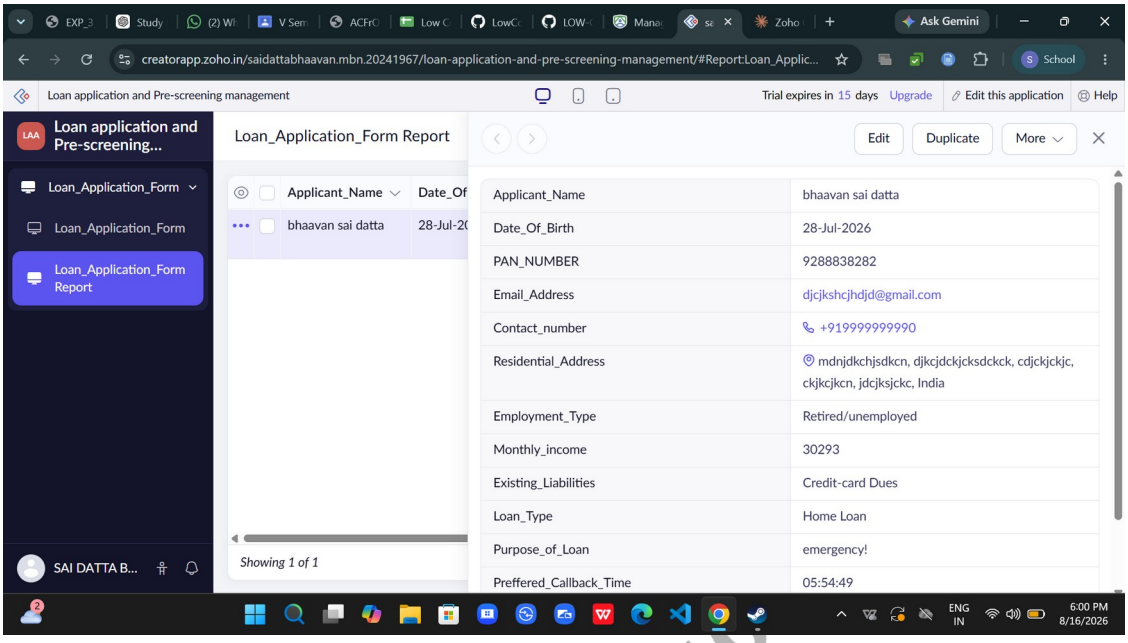
Live Preview — Existing Liabilities and Section D (Loan Type, Purpose of Loan, Preferred Callback Time)



Live Preview — Consent_For_Credit_Check field (single mandatory checkbox)

3. Loan_Application_Report — Sample Submitted Records

Three sample loan applications were submitted through the live form. The individual submitted records, as viewed from the Loan_Application_Report detail view, are shown below.

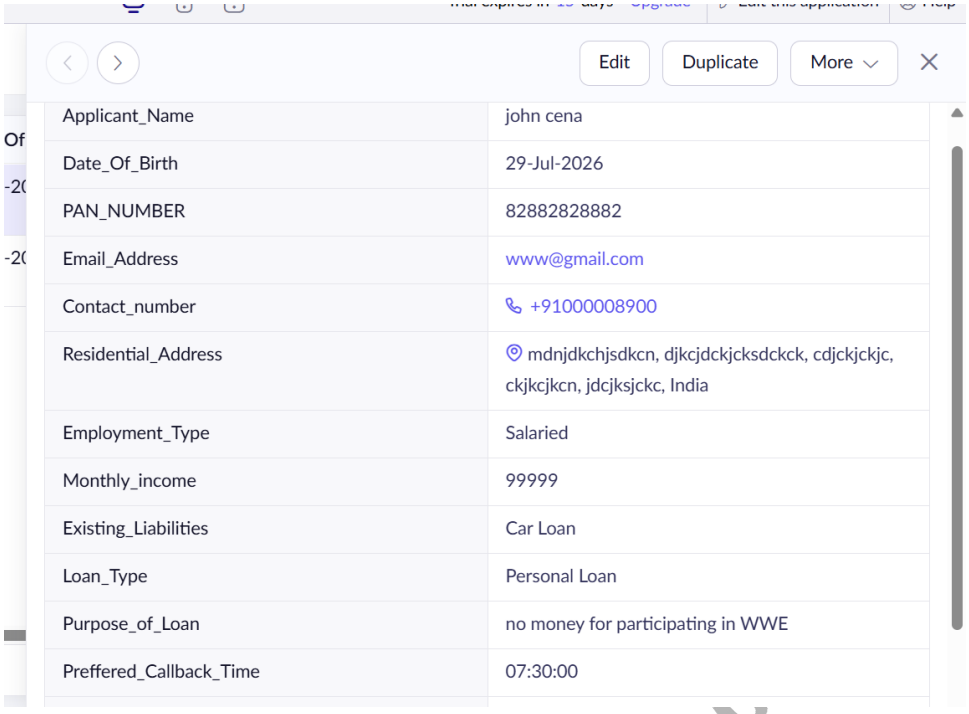


Sample Record 1 — Loan_Application_Report detail view

Edit Duplicate More

Applicant_Name	bill gates
Date_Of_Birth	17-Aug-2026
PAN_NUMBER	33300003303
Email_Address	billgates@gmail.com
Contact_number	+9100099900
Residential_Address	mdnjdkchjsdkcn, djkcjdckjcksdckck, cdjckjckjc, ckjkcjkcn, jdcjksjckc, India
Employment_Type	self-employed
Monthly_income	99999
Existing_Liabilities	Personal Loan
Loan_Type	Educational Loan
Purpose_of_Loan	wanting to learn new skills from harvard university and again rule the world as multi millionaire

Sample Record 2 — Loan_Application_Report detail view



Sample Record 3 — Loan_Application_Report detail view

RESULT

A Bank Loan Application Form application was successfully designed and built in Zoho Creator using all thirteen Basic Fields — Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select, and Checkbox. The fields were logically grouped into four sections through drag-and-drop, mandatory and format-level validations were configured successfully, and the Loan_Application_Report was verified to correctly capture and list applicant data submitted through the form. The exercise thus demonstrated an understanding of data modelling and low-code form design for a real banking business use case.

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